CLASS 10 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 13–17: **Power-sharing (Political Science), Federalism (Political Science), Gender, Religion and Caste (Political Science), Political Parties (Political Science), Outcomes of Democracy (Political Science)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Assertion (A): Power sharing between the Union Government and State Governments is called vertical division of power. Reason (R): It involves governments at higher and lower levels. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

2. Match the type of federation with the example: 1 Coming together; 2 Holding together with A India; B USA; C Unitary; D Sri Lanka. Which is correct? 1

(a) 1-A, 2-B **(b)** 1-B, 2-A **(c)** 1-C, 2-D **(d)** 1-D, 2-C

3. Assertion (A): Caste alone cannot determine election results in India. Reason (R): No parliamentary constituency has a clear majority of one single caste. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

4. A party has units in several States, all following the policies and programmes decided at the national level. It is most likely a: 1

(a) State party **(b)** pressure group
(c) national party **(d)** independent candidate

5. If ministers' decisions are secret, democracy loses: 1

(a) elections **(b)** multiple parties **(c)** symbols **(d)** transparency

6. A state proposes that every law must be approved by a majority of members from each language group. This resembles: 1

(a) a coalition **(b)** the Lebanese rule
(c) a Belgian safeguard **(d)** a Sri Lankan majoritarian act

7. Which of these statements best explains why local government is the best way to realise local self-government? 1

(a) Local bodies make laws on defence
(b) Local people know their problems better and can participate directly
(c) Local governments do not require elections
(d) Local bodies have more powers than the Union Government

8. Assertion (A): The role of women in public life, especially politics, is minimal in most societies. Reason (R): The sexual division of labour keeps women mainly in housework. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

9. When people say a party suffers 'lack of meaningful choice', what is a proper test? 1

(a) Whether they have symbols
(b) Whether they have members
(c) Whether they contest every seat
(d) Whether parties' policies differ significantly

10. Which of these statements about Nannu's case is correct? 1

(a) His application under the Right to Information Act led officials to act within a week
(b) His duplicate card was never issued
(c) He had to bribe the officials
(d) The officer refused to meet him

11. A constitution that directs the state to protect and foster one religion makes members of other religions feel alienated. This is closest to which Sri Lankan step? 1

(a) protecting and fostering Buddhism
(b) the Sinhala Only Act
(c) preferential policies for jobs
(d) the demand for Tamil Eelam

12. Assertion (A): Gram sabhas are not held regularly in many places. Reason (R): Most States have not transferred significant powers and resources to local governments. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

13. Which provision gives 33 per cent reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies? 1

(a) Time Use Survey 1998-99
(b) Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023
(c) Census of 2011
(d) Equal Remuneration Act, 1976

14. The remark 'parties are partial, partisan and lead to partitions' is best answered in the chapter by noting that parties: 1

(a) create all divisions
(b) are the same as pressure groups
(c) reflect existing social and political divisions and also perform functions that democracy needs
(d) should be abolished

15. Which of these has democracy been least successful at, according to the chapter? 1

(a) creating conditions for open public debate
(b) reducing economic inequalities
(c) producing a legitimate government
(d) holding regular and free elections

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Which of the two stories shows an accommodation and which shows majoritarianism? 2

17. How does reservation work in local bodies? 2

18. Why is the reservation in local bodies for SC, ST, OBC and women important? 2

19. Why does the chapter say party systems cannot be chosen? 2

20. What does it mean to say 'democracy appeals to some of our deep values'? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Analyse the data to show that inequality varies among democracies. 3

22. Justify the statement that democratic power sharing needs trust. 3

23. Examine why the Constitution gave residuary powers to the Union Government. 3

24. What lessons does the chapter draw from the persistence of untouchability? 3

OR

Why are the sources of money for parties a concern? 3

25. Discuss whether democracy can be held responsible for farmer suicides. 3

OR

Evaluate the argument that accommodation is complicated and therefore not useful. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Explain why political parties are both indispensable and unpopular in a democracy. 5

OR

Assess the claim that democracy is slow and therefore inefficient. 5

27. Analyse how Sri Lanka's civil war could have been avoided according to the chapter's reasoning. 5

OR

Discuss the role of language in the Indian federal experience with Sri Lanka as a contrast. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks